



XIANGQI

VARIANT LIBRARY

Ancient Chinese chess: cannon fire, palace tactics, and the river divide

9

VARIANTS

2

PLAYERS

8+

AGE

Published by Moddable Games · vl.2.1 · Printed 22 July 2026

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Xiangqi (, “Elephant Chess”) is one of the world’s most played strategy board games, tracing its origins to China no later than the 7th century. Played on the intersection points of a 9×10 grid, it features a river dividing the board, a palace restricting the General and Advisors, and the Cannon: a piece that can only capture by jumping over exactly one other piece.

This library includes 9 playable variants spanning the Chinese and Korean branches of the family.

CHINESE CHESS

- ♦ [Standard Xiangqi](#) — The classic form: 9×10 board, river divide, Flying General rule, and the screen-jumping Cannon

KOREAN CHESS

- ♦ [Janggi](#) — Korean Chess: no river, longer Elephant movement, Cannon must jump to move and capture, and the bikjang facing-Generals rule

ASYMMETRIC VARIANTS

- ♦ [Manchu+](#) — Qing Dynasty asymmetric game: the Manchu side loses Horses and Cannons, gaining a single Banner piece that combines Chariot, Cannon, and Horse

SMALLER BOARD VARIANTS

- ♦ [Minixiangqi](#) — Xiangqi on a 7×7 board; no Advisors or Elephants; Soldiers move sideways from the start
- ♦ [Xiangqi 42](#) — Compact 7×6 board (42 intersections); designed by Robert Price for the 42-Squares Contest (2001)

REGIONAL / EXPANDED VARIANTS

- ♦ [Quang Trung Chess](#) — Vietnamese 10×10 variant with Pawn promotion as an alternate win condition; named for Emperor Quang Trung
- ♦ [Yang Qi](#) — Western-influenced 9×10 redesign replacing most Xiangqi pieces with FIDE equivalents; Cannon extended to diagonals

HIDDEN INFORMATION VARIANTS

- ♦ [Jieqi](#) — Dark Chess: all pieces except the General start face-down and reveal on first move; growing rapidly in China and Vietnam

MULTIPLAYER VARIANTS

- ♦ San-kwo-k'i — Three Kingdoms 3-player Xiangqi on a hexagonal trisected board; eliminating a General captures that player's entire army



Printed 22 July 2026

V1.2.1